

Changkun Ou, Ph.D.

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Resume

@changkun 

changkun.de 

Staff Engineer | Ph.D. in Computer Science, LMU Munich

Leading organization-wide AI transformation across revenue management, customer service, B2B sales, and SRE. Architecting enterprise AI platforms while delivering measurable business outcomes including 2.5% margin uplift through human-in-the-loop optimization. Research background in human-AI interaction (310+ citations, h-index 9), combining theoretical insight with robust engineering to build scalable production systems. See [Research Portfolio](#).

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Media Informatics (Dr. rer. nat.)

LMU Munich

Feb. 2019 – Apr. 2023

Munich, Germany

- **Thesis:** *"The Intelligence in the Loop: Empirical Explorations and Reflections"*, Magna cum Laude
- **Thesis Committee:** Prof. Dr.-Ing. [Andreas Butz](#) (Erstberichterstatter), Prof. Dr. [Eyke Hüllermeier](#) (Zweitberichterstatter), Prof. Dr.-Ing. [Marc Stamminger](#) (Drittberichterstatter).

Master Student Human-Computer Interaction (M.Sc.)

LMU Munich; overall grade: 1.63 (max. 1.0) between "Very Good" and "Good"

Oct. 2016 – Jan. 2019

Munich, Germany

- **Thesis:** *"Understanding and Predicting Web Browsing Behavior"*
- **Advisors:** Dr. [Daniel Buschek](#), Dr. [Malin Eiband](#), Prof. Dr. [Heinrich Hußmann](#)

Bachelor Student Computer Science and Engineering (B.Eng.)

Southwest University for Nationalities; overall grade: 3.74 (max. 4.0), ranked 1st of 154 students

Sep. 2012 – Jul. 2016

Chengdu, China

- **Thesis:** *"Designing Alternative Contact-free Control Modalities for Smart Watches"*
- **Advisor:** Prof. Dr. [Yaxi Chen](#)

RECENT PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer (promoted from Software Engineer)

[Sixt SE](#)

Sep. 2022 – Present

Munich Pullach, Germany

- **As AI transformation lead:** Leading organization-wide AI transformation across revenue management, customer service, B2B sales, and SRE platform domains.
- **As AI platform lead:** Architected enterprise AI platform: AI chat interface, self-service agent builder, company-wide agent framework with eval pipeline, centralized LLM gateway, knowledge management system, workflow orchestration, low-code platform, and document processing pipeline.
- **As engineer:** Led 637+ PRs across 50+ repositories in 2025; built competition-based pricing, compliance infrastructure, AI security and governance; designed revenue optimization systems driving 2.5% margin uplift; made yield systems 300x faster enabling 10x business scale.
- **As mentor:** Mentored engineers through technically challenging projects and actively contributed to building and scaling high-performing engineering teams.

Research Associate, Lecturer

LMU Munich

Apr. 2018 – Mar. 2023, Apr. 2024 – Present

Munich, Germany

- **As lecturer:** Supervised 18 students in conducting scientific research
- **As researcher:** Researched human-in-the-loop machine learning for 3D graphics systems
- **As teacher:** Taught 12 classes (as lecturer/instructor/assistant/tutor) and supervised 20+ student theses and seminars
- **As developer:** Developed a 3D mesh processing backend system in collaboration with industry partner [WAY digital solutions](#); developed, migrated, and maintained a 17-year-old [university CMS system](#) and a 13-year-old [collaborative system](#)

PUBLICATIONS

See [my research page](#) or [Google Scholar](#) for more details.

EXPERTISE AND SKILLS

The following outlines years of experience and provides an estimated proficiency level:

- **Domain:** *LLM-based AI* (2 years of industry practice, *experienced*); *Computer graphics* (3D rendering and geometry processing, 3 years of Bachelors level teaching at university, 2 years of Masters level teaching, Blender/OpenGL/Metal/three.js, *experienced*); *Machine learning* (1 year of Masters level teaching at university, 2 years of industrial practices, sklearn/tensorflow/pytorch/etc, *experienced*); *Data analysis* (3 years of PhD research, numpy/seaborn/pandas/etc., 2 years of industrial data analysis, *experienced*); *Web development* (2 years of industrial backend engineering, Go/React/etc., *experienced*).
- **Language:** *Go* (9+ years, *expert*); *Python* (7+ years, *experienced*); *LaTeX* (10+ years, *expert*); *C/C++* (5+ years, *intermediate*); *JavaScript/TypeScript* (5+ years, *intermediate*); I speak native Mandarin; fluent professional English; elementary German.

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

ACM SIGCHI Gary Marsden Travel Awards <i>Full Travel Support</i>	Jan. 2023
ACM Symposium on Virtual Reality Software and Technology <i>Best Paper Award</i>	Nov. 2022
ACM SIGCHI Mensch und Computer <i>Honorable Mention Award</i>	Sep. 2022
ACM SIGCHI Special Recognitions (CHI '20) <i>Outstanding Reviews</i>	Nov. 2019
Siemens AILab Hackathon <i>2nd Winner</i>	Nov. 2017 <i>Munich, Germany</i>
China National Scholarship <i>University of Electronic Science and Technology of China</i>	Sep. 2016 <i>Chengdu, China</i>
Excellent Bachelor Thesis Award <i>Southwest University for Nationalities</i>	Jun. 2016 <i>Chengdu, China</i>
Best University Graduates Award <i>Sichuan Province</i>	Jan. 2016 <i>Chengdu, China</i>
China National Scholarship <i>Southwest University for Nationalities</i>	Sep. 2014 <i>Chengdu, China</i>
Meritorious Winner in American Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM' 14) <i>Southwest University for Nationalities</i>	Apr. 2014 <i>Chengdu, China</i>

VOLUNTEERING

Associate Chair (Computational Interaction) <i>The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems</i>	CHI '24, CHI '25, CHI '26
Associate Chair (Human-Centred Intelligent Interactive Systems) <i>The IFIP TC13 International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction</i>	INTERACT '25
Reviewing <i>CHI '20 - CHI'23, MobileHCI' 2023, ICMI' 2022, IMWUT' 2022, INTERACT' 2021</i>	